

NEWS FROM OUR NATIONAL CAPITAL

Insurgents Defeated in Fight Over Appointment of Committee Member.

Washington.—About the only event of more than ordinary interest in Congress during the past week was the fight in the house over the appointment of a successor to the late E. H. Madison on the committee on rules, the committee which controls the legislative proceedings. It precipitated the first conflict of the session between the Insurgent and Regular Republicans. The Insurgents went down to defeat and the Regulars with the aid of Democratic votes succeeded in electing Philip B. Campbell of Kansas over Victor Murdock. A resolution to place Warburton, another insurgent, on the sugar trust committee was lost by a large vote.

Small River and Harbor Bill Likely
Oscar Underwood, floor leader of the ways and means committee, is not at all sure that river and harbor legislation will be undertaken at this session. He predicates his doubt on the fact that there is an estimated deficit in the treasury for this fiscal year of \$18,000,000—and on the recent legislation affecting pensions. He frankly says that if the Sherwood bill, as passed by the house, is permitted to stand, it would so cripple the treasury that no new projects or expenditures could be authorized, leaving public buildings and rivers and harbors to another session, except for projects already under continuing contracts.

Political Information Sought
Seeking information regarding the political situation seems to be the chief occupation of most men in Washington at this time. It is almost certain that a man going through the capitol these days will be asked by nine out of every ten men he meets as to the political conditions and to give his guess as to whom both parties will nominate.

The Democratic situation is chaotic and there never was a time when there was so much uncertainty as to who will be the standard bearer, but it seems rather strange that there should be any inquiry regarding the Republican candidate in view of the certainty among most men a few weeks ago that Taft would be renominated. It shows what a change has been created by the fact that Roosevelt will do nothing to prevent his friends from going forward with an effort to nominate him. That is what has upset all calculations regarding the Republican situation.

Employers' Liability Law Upheld.
The constitutionality of the employers' liability law passed by congress in 1908 was upheld by the supreme court of the United States in all cases before it. The court also decided that state courts may enforce that act when local laws are appropriate.

This was the second and finally successful effort of congress to change the old common law rule that an employee of a common carrier could not procure damages from the carrier for injuries resulting from the negligence of a fellow servant.

Taft Is Not Angry With Hitchcock.
Postmaster General Hitchcock's proposal that the government acquire all the telegraph lines in the country and operate them in conjunction with the postoffice department, caused a flood of comment.

After the postmaster-general had been in conference with President Taft an authoritative statement was made at the White House that there had been no friction between the president and the postmaster-general over the latter's proposal.

Speaker Champ Clark declared that government telegraph was too big a subject to discuss until all the details of the postmaster-general's plan became known. Democratic Leader Underwood was reticent and Republican Leader Mann, of the House, treated the project glacially.

National Capitol Brevities
Vice President Sherman expects to see the present session of congress extend beyond the national conventions.

Secretary of War Stimson strongly urges the passage of a bill to supply discarded army Krag-Jorgensen rifles and ammunition to schools and rifle clubs.

In the opinion of Senator Borah, congress will pass a bill in some form giving the people an opportunity to vote on the direct election of United States senators.

In a message to congress, President Taft announced that this government would refuse to admit free wood pulp and paper from any government other than Canada until the courts had settled the question.

To encourage settlement and make homesteading easier, Senator Chamberlain will introduce a bill providing that any homesteader after six months' continuous residence, may be entitled to leave of absence for six months of each year.

Here is a remedy that will cure your cold. Why waste time and money experimenting when you can get a preparation that has won a world-wide reputation by its cures of this disease and can always be depended upon? It is known everywhere as Chamberlain's Cough Remedy, and is a medicine of real merit. For sale by all dealers.

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A Split Coin

By ANNA B. WRIGHT

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It was the poetess Mrs. Browning, I believe, who said that while love is but a portion of man's life it is a woman's whole existence, or words to that effect. While there are many exceptions to the rule, there is no doubt that woman treasures a love, or at least its memory, longer than a man. Miss Amelia Dexter has the half of a silver ten cent piece which has been in her possession thirty years. At any rate, she was treasuring it till recently, when she met the man who gave it to her. What she has done with it since nobody knows.

When Amelia was seventeen she visited her aunt, the wife of a professor of the Naval academy at Annapolis. There she met a young midshipman who smiled upon her, showing a beautiful set of white teeth, while his eyes laughed with every other feature. The girl collapsed at once. Whether her love for the young man strengthened is a question. More likely it was born all at once.

Nevertheless Cadet Williams and Amelia Dexter "paired off," as young people call being exclusively devoted to each other. Williams was Miss Dexter's escort to the cadet dances and accompanied her in her walks. No other girl aspired to any attention from him, and Amelia received no attention from any other cadet. In short, there was between them one of those innocent relations which have not the formality of an engagement—a sort of natural youthful emotion preliminary to mating. In a man it is usually a pleasant tenderness which may or may not take root. It may be the same in a girl, yet there are cases wherein it has been an undying love.

There were special auxiliaries in this case, the academy band discoursing martial music, the cadet corps marching on and off parade, the formal salutes between officers and between officers and cadets. There is an autocracy among men trained to fight as well as a certain swagger, probably intended to overbalance the fact that what they are being educated for is to be killed. Nevertheless it is fascinating to the young of both sexes, who take very little account of what it is for. It has always figured largely in love.

Amelia spent a couple of months at Annapolis, then went home to begin another year at school. The nearest thing to an understanding between her and her cadet lover was the split coin. As to an engagement, neither of them thought of such a matter of fact proceeding. They had not grown mature enough to make an arrangement for a lifetime. They lived and loved only for the present. The future was or seemed to be too far for their consideration.

The split coin represented what they felt, and its intrinsic value about 30 per cent of its current value represented the real depth of their affection.

That is, for the boy. As to the girl, this is one of the cases the poet described. It was not an egg to be developed. It was born perfect and indestructible. She left Annapolis with her half a coin hidden away in her bosom, while underneath it burned a flame like that kept alive by vestal virgins.

What transpired from that time till thirty years had passed is not a part of this story. Miss Dexter is now an old maid. Williams is an admiral and a grandfather. One summer there was a naval war game on the Atlantic coast. At a reception given to the officers of the fleet Miss Dexter, an elderly spinster, was present. Admiral Williams was introduced to her. They chatted awhile, when Miss Dexter began to ask him leading questions. She spoke of a certain moonlight evening on the porch of one of the professors of the Naval academy. Then and there he had given her her first kiss. She contented herself with mentioning certain correlative incidents. The admiral didn't twig. She referred to a ride on the water in which they sat side by side in a retired corner, his arm encircling her waist. The admiral did not even remember the boat ride. She mentioned certain circumstances connected with their last parting. The admiral wondered what she was driving at.

Then the admiral began to rally her on not having married, saying that it was undoubtedly her own fault. She admitted that she had had an affair when very young with a naval officer, and taking in her hand a fine gold chain she wore about her neck, drew from her bosom half a dime. She told the admiral that the man who had kept the other half had forgotten her.

"If you'll tell me who he is," replied Williams, "and if he is ever under my command I'll make him wish he had a better memory."

Miss Dexter sighed, but made no reply. The admiral blustered about the fine sense of honor of officers of the navy in matters pertaining to women, declaring that the saying that a sailor has a sweetheart in every port is a slur on the service. Then, being called away, he made a profound bow and continued to pour forth his repository of complaints upon the next woman he met.

Why did not Miss Dexter tell him that he was the recipient lover? Had her love died as his had died perhaps she would have enjoyed his discomfiture at the revelation. But with her it was as a child is to its mother—though dead, it always lives.



FRENCH AND GERMAN COLORS

Supposed Origin of the Tricolor and the Teuton Flag.

For five centuries black and white have been the Hohenzollern colors, and the first verse of the German war song, "Ich bin ein Preusse," is: "I am a Prussian! Know ye not my banner?" Before me floats my flag of black and white!

My fathers died for freedom; 'twas their banner—So say these colors floating in your sight.

The mercantile marine tricolor of black, white and red is emblematic of the joining of the Hohenzollern black and white with the red and white, which was the ensign of the Hanseatic league. This flag came into being when the North German Confederacy was established, Nov. 25, 1867, at the close of the Austro-Prussian war. The red and white represent the commercial prosperity of the nation, while the black and white symbolize the strong arm of the state prepared to protect and foster it.

Nowhere have historical events carried so much change in the standards and national ensigns of a country as in France. The oriflamme and the chape de St. Martin were succeeded at the end of the sixteenth century, when Henry III., the last of the house of Valois, came to the throne, by the white standard powdered fleur-de-lis.

That in turn gave place to the famous tricolor which was introduced at the time of the revolution, but the origin of that flag and its colors is a disputed question. Some maintain that the intention was to combine in the flag the blue of the chape de St. Martin, the red of the oriflamme and the white flag of the Bourbons. By others the colors are said to be those of the city of Paris. Yet again other authorities assert that the flag is copied from the shield of the Orleans family as it appeared after Philippe Egalite had knocked off the fleur-de-lis—Kansas City Star.

A BIT OF NAVAL HISTORY.

Origin of the Corps of Professors of Mathematics.

Before the Naval academy was established midshipmen received their education entirely on board ship. Their technical education was obtained in the school of experience, helped out occasionally by the voluntary efforts of the older line officers. Their general education was at first neglected, but later instructors were appointed for service on ships that carried midshipmen. These were appointed by the secretary of the navy for stated periods, much as civilian instructors at the Naval academy are appointed at the present time. In 1842 a general order was issued providing that they should live and mess with lieutenants. They were commissioned in 1848, but specific rank was not given them until the general reorganization of all staff corps during the civil war.

The late Professor H. H. Lockwood, U. S. N., in some very interesting reminiscences read before the Naval Academy Graduates' association in 1893 relates how the corps of professors of mathematics came to be formed. In the early days of the Naval academy he was one of its instructors. He had had service in the army, and in the development of the course of instruction he determined, after consultation with the superintendent, to give the midshipmen a little infantry drill. This did not suit the proud spirits of the young gentlemen of that day, and to show their disapproval of this and other efforts of the professor they hung him in effigy. An investigation and a court martial followed on the charge of insulting a superior officer.

The defense put up the plea that the instructor was not a superior officer. Such a condition is hard to understand at this time, when the status of officers, instructors and midshipmen at the Naval academy is well defined, but at that time midshipmen were officers, while instructors had no official standing. The plea was technically correct, and to punish the guilty midshipmen it was found necessary to substitute charges in which the anomalous position of the professor in the naval service could not be made to enter. Upon these the guilty midshipmen were condemned and punished.

This incident led to an amendment to the naval appropriation bill of 1848 giving authority to the commissioning of twelve professors of mathematics—Commander U. T. Holmes in Engineering Magazine.

A Simple Get-rich-quick Scheme.

Take 1,000,000 cats and get rich quick. This is the advice of the Liberte of Paris to its readers. The prescription is quite simple. A million cats will supply you with 12,000,000 kittens a year. The skins are worth a little over 28 cents each, so there you have a daily gross revenue of about \$10,000. To skin the cats you will have to employ 100 men, who will charge you \$2 per fifty cats. Your net revenue will thus be reduced to about \$9,000 a day. It should cost you nothing to feed your cats. Start a rattery. Rats breed four times as fast as cats, so the cats can have a daily diet of four rats apiece, which is ample. To feed the rats is perfectly simple. Give them the skinning cats. One cat will be ample for four rats. The scheme works out simply and automatically. The cats eat, the rats eat the cats, and you have the skins.

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PETE BROWNING'S BATS.

They Still Served the Old Slugger After He Quit Baseball.

One of the oldest and most eccentric characters baseball has ever produced was old Pete Browning, the famous slugger, who played with Louisville around the eighties and later joined the Cleveland club in 1890 during the Brotherhood war.

Pete was a little off in his roof garden and had only one idea in his head day or night. Anything that concerned his precious batting average was meat and drink to him. It made no difference how many fly balls he dropped or let get by him as long as he landed two or three safe ones during a game.

Bats were a mania with Browning, and whenever he could pick up a club which suited him it was added to his enormous collection. So many were gathered at various points on some of his trips that he sometimes was forced to pay excess baggage on the prizes.

According to Van Halgren, it was Browning who introduced the habit of rubbing down a bat with tobacco juice, which custom is followed to this day by many of the players. The idea is to roughen the surface of the stick and prevent so many fouls slipping off one side or the other.

Browning, who was a great user of the weed, used to polish down his sticks in this way without any apparent reason until he commenced to believe that it made a difference with his hitting, and after that no wagon tongue of his ever escaped a coating of the obnoxious fluid.

Other players took it up in the hope of emulating Browning, and now it is a common custom throughout the country.

When Pete retired from the game all the bats, relics of former days, were still in his possession. In order to keep them always in his sight Pete had them turned down to a uniform size and used them as posts for the baluster in his house.

To the day of his death they remained the most valued of his possessions.—New York World.

ENGLISHMEN'S GAMES.

Quaint Hindu View of the Beating and Kicking of Balls.

Some amusing descriptions of East Indian life are given in Mrs. Penny's book, "The Rajah." Here is a Hindu servant's opinion of the English devotion to ball games, given to four rani-princesses—whom he was trying to enlighten:

"The English," he said, "all play ball. Some beat balls with iron shod sticks, standing in the fields and striking with sufficient force to break a man's skull; some beat the ball with a long bit of wood in front of three sticks that represent their gods, some with corded spoons over a net wall, some with long handled hammers as they sit on horses; some kick the ball with their feet. The balls are of all sizes from a small orange to a man's head."

"By whose orders do they kick and beat balls?" he was asked.

"By order of their pujaris," the sycophant replied, "and he must know, because he serves the writing sahib."

"Why should such an order be given?" asked the second rani.

"They are a fierce and warlike people, those English, who must be always fighting and beating some one. It is by this means only that they are prevented from killing each other."

"But the Misses Sahib—would she, too, beat and fight?"

"She is strong. Who knows? At Bombay and Calcutta the English ladies beat balls over the wall of net. They do it that they may bear children fierce and strong like their fathers. When the babies are but a few months old they give them balls to beat with their little hands and to creep after as soon as they can move by themselves."

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Remember Rexall Remedies can be obtained in this community only at our store, The Rexall Store, Huntley Bros. Co. Oregon City, Ore.

Trains Wrecked; Three Dead.

Topeka, Kan.—Three are known to be dead and ten more or less seriously injured when two trains were wrecked on the Missouri Pacific a mile west of Norton Lyndon.

VAGARIES OF THE TIDE.

Mysterious Currents, the Secrets of Which No One Has Solved.

There are as many vagaries in the waters as in the winds. Why, for instance, should great ocean currents send their warm waters across the wide Pacific and Atlantic? Other and equally mysterious currents exist in well nigh all parts of the world.

It is on record that the sea has run for weeks out of the Java sea, through the strait of Sunda and thence back again for a like period without any perceptible rise and fall during those times.

Then there is the equatorial current that flows into the Caribbean sea, the ever flowing current to the eastward around Cape Horn, the cold stream flowing from the icy regions of the north past Newfoundland and Nova Scotia and along the American coast to the extreme end of Florida, the continual current running with a velocity of from four to five knots an hour through the strait of Gibraltar into the Mediterranean sea, the swift current running across the rocks and shoals off the end of Britain island, which apparently starts from nowhere and ends somewhere in the vicinity of the same place, and the current which, starting halfway up the China sea, runs from two to three knots an hour to the northeast and finally ends abruptly off the north end of Luzon.

Then we have those tidal vagaries known the world over as bores. Those that run up the Hugli and Irrawadi rivers, from side to side, till they reach their limit, often tearing the ships from their anchorage, originate nobody knows where or why.

At Singapore it has been observed for days at a time that there has been but one rise and fall in the twenty-four hours.—Boston Globe.

A Queer Monument.

A monument erected in the Straglieno cemetery has a very curious history. It is that of an old woman of Genoa, who made a living by selling strings of nuts in the streets. By frugality and industry she succeeded in amassing a small fortune in this way and then commissioned a well known sculptor of Genoa, Luigi Orero, to make a life sized portrait of her in marble just as she appeared at her pitch in the streets. This statue she ordered to be placed in the famous Straglieno cemetery, probably the largest in the world.—Wide World Magazine.

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Summons

In the Circuit Court of the State of Oregon for the County of Clackamas.

Grace Jossa, Plaintiff,

vs.

Carlos A. Jossa, Defendant.

To Carlos A. Jossa, above named defendant:

In the name of the state of Oregon you are hereby required to appear and answer the complaint filed against you in the above entitled suit on or before six weeks from the first publication of this summons, to-wit: the 19th day of January, 1912, and if you fail to so appear and answer, for want thereof the plaintiff will apply to the Court for the relief demanded in the complaint filed in this suit, to-wit:

For a decree of the Court dissolving the bonds of matrimony heretofore and now existing between the plaintiff and defendant, Carlos A. Jossa; granting and restoring to the plaintiff her maiden name Grace Velma Taylor.

This summons is served upon you by publication thereof six consecutive weeks in the Oregon City Courier, by order of the Hon. R. B. Beatie, Judge of the County Court, which order is dated the 8th day of December, 1911.

The date of the first publication hereof is the 8th day of December, 1911, and the date of the last publication hereof is the 19th day of January, 1912.

JOHN J. BECKMAN,
Attorney for Plaintiff,
422-3-4 Yeon Building,
Portland, Oregon.

Summons

In the Circuit Court of the State of Oregon, for the County of Clackamas.

Della Prince, Plaintiff,

vs.

M. T. Prince, Defendant.

To M. T. Prince, defendant.

In the name of the State of Oregon, you are hereby required to appear in the above entitled Court, and answer the complaint filed against you in this suit, on or before February 16, 1912, and if you fail to so appear and answer said complaint, the plaintiff will apply